

Word family: **overall / overalls**

Base word: overall

Related form: overalls

Part of speech: adverb (副詞) / adjective (形容詞) / noun in **overalls** (名詞複數形式)

Your sentence:

> **“Overall**, that advertisement was persuasive because it solved a real problem and made the product seem useful, comforting, and luxurious.”

A semantic note first: **overall** does not have many unrelated meanings. It has one strong core idea:

> **considering everything together as a whole, rather than focusing on individual details**

The clothing word **overalls** is a genuinely separate family extension.

Meaning in this passage

Here, **overall** means:

considering all the different aspects of the advertisement together and giving a general final judgment.

繁體中文: **綜合所有方面來看; 整體而言; 總體來說**

Natural translation:

> “Overall, that advertisement was persuasive...”

「**整體而言／總的來說**，那則廣告很有說服力……」

So here:

overall = 綜合前面提到的所有細節後，從整體角度作出總結

1. **overall** (總結整體情況) — **整體而言; 總的來說**

Here, **overall** is an adverb.

Meaning: Considering everything or all relevant aspects together.

Practice 1 — Original

> “**Overall**, that advertisement was persuasive.”

「**整體而言**，那則廣告很有說服力。」

Practice 2

> “**Overall**, I was satisfied with the headphones.”

「**總體來說**，我對這副耳機感到滿意。」

Practice 3

> “The trip had a few problems, but **overall** it was enjoyable.”

「這趟旅程雖然有幾個問題，但**整體而言**還是很愉快。」

****overall — adverb = 把所有優點、缺點和不同方面綜合起來後，從整體角度作出判斷****

This is especially common in:

- * conclusions
- * reviews
- * evaluations
- * essays
- * presentations

2. ****overall + noun (整體結果／情況／表現) — 整體的; 總體的****

Here, ****overall**** is an adjective.

Practice 4

> “The ****overall quality**** of the product is excellent.”

「產品的****整體品質****非常出色。」

Practice 5

> “Customer feedback had a positive effect on the ****overall result****.”

「顧客意見對**整體結果**產生了正面影響。」

overall + noun = 涵蓋所有主要部分並把它們視為一個整體的

Common combinations:

* **overall quality** = 整體品質

* **overall performance** = 整體表現

* **overall result** = 整體結果

* **overall impression** = 整體印象

* **overall effect** = 整體效果

* **overall cost** = 總成本

* **overall score** = 總分／整體評分

3. **overall = total across all parts/groups (全部合計) — 總體的; 全部合計的**

This is still part of the adjective sense, but the emphasis is specifically on **totality**.

Practice 6

> “The **overall cost** was higher than expected.”

「**總成本**比預期高。」

Practice 7

> “There was an **overall increase** in sales.”

「銷售額出現了**整體增長／總體上升**。」

overall = 把不同部分、組別或數字合併後所得的總體情況

This is especially common in:

* business

* statistics

* reports

* research

4. ****overall impression/view/picture (綜合觀感／大局) — 整體印象; 整體看法; 全貌****

A very useful contextual branch.

Practice 8

> “My ****overall impression**** of the hotel was positive.”

「我對這間酒店的****整體印象****是正面的。」

Practice 9

> “We need to look at the ****overall picture****, not just one bad result.”

「我們需要看****整體情況／全貌****, 而不是只看一個差的結果。」

****overall impression/picture = 綜合所有細節後形成的整體觀感或全貌****

5. ****overall winner/champion (所有組別合計後) — 總冠軍; 總排名第一****

****Meaning:**** The person or team that performs best when all categories, rounds, or results are considered together.

Practice 10

> “She was the ****overall winner**** of the competition.”

「她是比賽的****總冠軍****。」

Practice 11

> “The team finished first ****overall****.”

「這支隊伍在****總排名中位列第一****。」

****overall — competition = 綜合所有項目、回合或成績後所得的總體排名****

Again, this grows from the same “considering everything together” concept.

6. ****overall majority / overall control (整體數量／控制權) — 總體多數; 全面控制****

This appears in institutional, organizational, and sometimes political contexts.

Practice 12

> “The company retained **overall control** of the project.”

「公司保留了對這個專案的**整體控制權**。」

Practice 13

> “One department has **overall responsibility** for safety.”

「有一個部門負責安全工作的**整體責任**。」

overall control/responsibility = 涵蓋所有主要部分，而不是只負責其中一個範圍

7. **overalls** = protective/work clothing — 工作服; 工裝連身服; 吊帶工裝褲

This is a genuinely different family extension.

In British English, **overalls** often means protective clothing worn over ordinary clothes, especially for work.

Practice 14

> “The mechanic was wearing blue **overalls**.”

「那名機械技工穿著藍色**工作服／工裝連身服**。」

Practice 15

> “Workers must wear protective **overalls** in the factory.”

「工人在工廠內必須穿上防護**工作服**。」

overalls = 工作時穿在身上、用來保護普通衣服或身體的工作服

Important note: **overalls** in British vs American English

This is worth knowing.

British English

****overalls**** can refer broadly to protective work clothing.

American English

****overalls**** very commonly means clothing with:

- * trousers,
- * a bib front,
- * shoulder straps,

what Traditional Chinese may call:

****吊帶工裝褲／工人吊帶褲****

So the exact clothing image can vary by region and context.

Important distinction: ****overall vs generally****

They overlap, but not perfectly.

****overall****

emphasizes a ****summary judgment after considering all parts****

> “Overall, the product is excellent.”

「綜合所有方面來看，產品很出色。」

****generally****

often means ****in most cases / usually / broadly speaking****

> “People generally liked the product.”

「大多數人普遍喜歡這件產品。」

So:

****overall = 綜合全部因素後****

****generally = 一般而言／大致上／通常****

Important distinction: **overall** vs on the whole

These are very close.

overall

> “Overall, I enjoyed the film.”

on the whole

> “On the whole, I enjoyed the film.”

Both:

「總的來說，我喜歡這部電影。」

On the whole is slightly more phrase-like and often suggests:

> despite some exceptions or problems, the general judgment is X.

Important distinction: **overall** vs in general

overall

often gives a conclusion about **one specific thing after considering its parts**.

> “Overall, the hotel was excellent.”

「整體來說，這間酒店很好。」

in general

often makes a broad statement about a class/category.

> “In general, hotels are expensive in this area.”

「一般來說，這個地區的酒店都很昂貴。」

Important distinction: **overall vs total**

They overlap in some contexts but are not identical.

overall

= considering all components together

total

= numerical sum or complete amount

> “overall performance”

= 整體表現

Not normally:

> **total performance** ❌ in the same sense

But:

> “total cost”

= 總成本

> “overall cost”

= 整體成本

Both can work, but **total** is more explicitly numerical.

Important distinction: **overall vs final**

You just curated **final**, so this distinction is useful.

overall

= judging the whole thing by combining all aspects

final

= coming at the end or being the last/conclusive version

> “overall impression”

= 綜合所有方面形成的整體印象

> “final impression”

= 最後留下的印象／最終印象

They are not interchangeable.

Word-position note

As an adverb, especially in summaries:

> “**Overall**, the experience was positive.”

Very common at the beginning of a sentence.

It can also appear later:

> “The experience was positive **overall**.”

「整體而言，這次經歷是正面的。」

As an adjective:

> “the **overall** result”

It comes before the noun.

Family-extension sweep

After a full sweep, this family is genuinely quite small:

* **overall — adverb** = 整體而言／總的來說

* **overall — adjective** = 整體的／總體的

* **overall result/performance/impression** = 整體結果／表現／印象

* **overall winner** = 總冠軍

* **overall control/responsibility** = 整體控制權／全面責任

* **overalls** = 工作服／工裝吊帶褲

There are not many useful derivational forms beyond these, so I would **not invent extra family members merely to make the list longer**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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overall — adverb	綜合所有相關方面、優缺點和細節後，從整體角度作出總結或判斷
overall + noun	涵蓋所有主要部分，並把它們視作一個整體的
overall — total situation	把不同部分、數字或組別合併後所得的總體情況
overall impression/picture	綜合所有細節後形成的整體觀感、全貌或總體看法
overall winner/ranking	綜合所有項目、回合或成績後所得的總排名／總冠軍
overall control/responsibility	涵蓋整個範圍而非單一部份的控制權／責任
overalls	工作時穿著以保護身體或衣服的工作服；美式亦常指吊帶工裝褲

For your original sentence

> “**Overall**, that advertisement was persuasive because it solved a real problem and made the product seem useful, comforting, and luxurious.”

The exact meaning is:

overall = 把廣告的內容、情感效果、實際功能和最終影響全部綜合起來後作出的總結判斷

So the most natural Traditional Chinese is:

> **「整體而言，那則廣告很有說服力……」**

or:

> **「總的來說，那則廣告很有說服力……」**

Here, **overall** works perfectly as a **concluding transition** because the speaker is moving from individual observations to a final judgment about the advertisement as a whole.